



Samsung's 3G camera

Samsung's 3G-connected Galaxy Camera lets users share pictures and videos on social networking sites directly

Infy Science Prize winners

Infosys announced the winners of its Science Prizes in engineering, computer science, humanities, life sciences, mathematics, physical sciences and social sciences



Rockstar finally released Max Payne 3 after a gap of nine years, and it was worth it!

games from the cloud. The processing would happen server-side. The feature was available for PC users as well as a streamer that could be connected to the TV. Unfortunately, the service never picked up, mostly due to the lag on screen due to the slow back end processing of the game. In the past few months, the service has seen a revamp and is currently being offered as a feature with LG Smart TV and Google TV sets.

Even though we have seen a rise of online gaming in India, the trends hasn't really reached its full potential due to one factor alone – Internet speeds. The average household has a minimum speed of 256 kbps or 512 kbps and these speeds aren't enough to take advantage of either console or PC online gaming.

Patent wars (Ugly)

Patent wars are nothing new to the world of technology, but the way they have played out this past year has been more childish than anything else. The Apple vs Samsung patent infringement lawsuit that began in 2011 doesn't seem to be reaching any meaningful end. The drama has seen the parties involved accusing each other of copying design elements ranging from the curved edges of the phone to the multi-touch gestures right up to the point that the icons look the same. If that's the case, we wonder why Apple hasn't sued a company like Micromax yet? We don't really know what's up with the US Patent and Trademark Office, as it recently awarded Apple a design patent for – flipping pages digitally.

Since the explanation of the patent wars can fill pages, here's a simple way of understanding it. *Street Fighter* and *Mortal Kombat*, are both fighting games. Both have char-

acters that move left and right on a screen and attack with kicks and punches along with special abilities. But fundamentally both the games are different even though certain mechanics are the same.

In the Apple vs Samsung patent war, the court awarded Apple more than \$1 billion in damages. For those of you that aren't aware, Apple sued Samsung claiming that the Korean giant has copied design elements from the iPhone and the iPad and implemented it in its own product catalogue. Apple went so far as to say that the icons on the Samsung device too were copied from Apple devices.

Apart from this Apple vs Samsung war, there have been quite a few patent battles happening. Here's a list of some:

1. HTC settles with Apple and agrees to pay royalties of an undisclosed sum to Apple.
2. An Apple lawsuit against Google's Motorola Mobility over alleged patent



VS



Apple Vs Samsung patent war was the legal battle of the year, and it's still on

abuse is thrown out by a Wisconsin Federal Court.

3. Oracle sues Google over seven patents relating to the use of Java in Android.
4. Microsoft files an ITC complaint and a lawsuit against Motorola over nine patents.
5. Nokia sues Apple in another German court over five patents.

The list is endless. The real loser in this battle of the patents is the consumer. With companies filing for silly patents that include the curved rectangular edges of a

device or the way that pages of an e-book are turned in an app, the number of truly innovative products in a particular category is going to be limited to the big players who can either afford to pay or afford to fight.

The true age of portability begins (Good)

If 2011 can be called the year where ultrabooks were introduced, then 2012 can easily be called the year when they went mainstream. One indicator of this was the launch of ultrabooks at various price points. The biggest development in 2012 was the launch of the second generation of ultrabooks on the latest Intel Ivy Bridge series processors. One noticeable change in ultrabooks was that they came with an mSATA SSD for caching in case the primary storage drive is a conventional HDD. This has truly helped the performance of the device.

The summer of 2012 saw a slew of ultrabooks from a variety of manufacturers such as Dell, HP, Samsung, Lenovo, to name a few all boasting of some impressive power under the hood the highlight of which was the Ivy Bridge processors.

Some game changing ultrabooks in the affordable category included the Dell Inspiron 14z, certain versions of the Lenovo IdeaPad U310 and U410 and the Samsung Series 5. The ultrabook has finally established itself as a viable alternative to the traditional laptop. Despite